

# Fishing Log — User Guide

Smith Mountain Lake · a private fishing log for our crew

Version 2.0 · created by John Parrent

Fishing Log is a free web app for logging your Smith Mountain Lake striper trips — what you caught, where, and under what conditions. Over time it builds YOUR playbook: which water temps, baits, moon phases, and spots actually produce. It runs in any web browser on your computer or phone. There is nothing to install.

**Web address:** <https://fishing-log-fmvre8u5mrqhfsgsfhxroj.streamlit.app>

## 1. Signing in

Open the web address above and click **Sign in with Google**. You'll use your regular Google account — there is no separate password to remember. Your trips are private to your email address: nobody else in the club can see your data, and you can't see theirs.

**First-time heads-up:** Google will show a screen that says "Google hasn't verified this app." Click **Advanced**, then **Go to Fishing Log**, then **Continue**. Google tacks the word "unsafe" onto that link only because our little club app hasn't gone through their formal (paid) verification process — the app itself is private and safe. You only see this screen once.

If sign-in tells you that you don't have access yet, your email hasn't been added to the approved list — just ask John Parrent (striper club member) to add you.

### Want to look around first?

Click **Try the Demo** on the sign-in page. You'll get a read-only tour with 15 sample trips already loaded so you can click through every page. Nothing you do in the demo can break anything.

## 2. Logging a trip (Log a Session)

This is the page you'll use most. Fill it out right at the dock — it takes about a minute.

### Set your spot(s) on the map

- Click the map to drop your starting pin. Click again to add each spot along your troll.
- The map opens centered on the water you fished **last trip** — handy if you pound the same spots.
- Check the box under a spot to mark where a fish was actually caught (shows a fish icon on the map).
- Use the **Last** button to undo the most recent pin or **Clear** to start over.

### Fill in the details

- Date, start/end time (dropdowns, 15-minute steps — hours fished computes automatically).
- Weather, air and water temperature, number of anglers.
- Bait/lure: pick one you've used before from the list, or type a new one.
- Style: Downlines, Jigging, Light Lines, Planer Boards, Topwater, Trolling, or Umbrella Rig.
- Notes: anything worth remembering — bait ball at 25 ft, birds working the point, etc.

## Enter your fish

In the **Fish caught** table, pick a species to start a row, then enter length, depth, and weight. Check **Kept?** for harvested fish (leave unchecked for released). Got skunked? Just leave the table alone — rows without a species are ignored.

The small checkbox on the far LEFT of each row is only for deleting rows: check it and a trash can appears at the top of the table. You don't need it for normal entry.

Hit **Save session** and you're done. A confirmation appears below the form along with the DWR report card (next section).

## 3. Filing your DWR striper report

Virginia DWR asks striper anglers to report each outing. The app does the paperwork for you: after you save a trip, a report card appears with your numbers already totaled.

- **Step 1 — Open pre-filled DWR report:** opens the official Google Form with your date, hours, anglers, and harvested/released counts and sizes already filled in. Review it and hit Submit.
- **Step 2 — Mark as filed to DWR:** check this box after you submit so the app knows it's done.

Once you check Step 2, that report is a done deal — the card switches to "Filed on (date)" and the buttons go away so nobody can accidentally double-file. If you later edit a filed trip, the app reminds you that the state already has its copy. Checked the box by mistake? There's an **Unmark** button inside the trip's edit form.

The Dashboard shows a reminder listing any trips you haven't filed yet.

## 4. Reviewing trips (Browse & Search)

- Filter by date range, location, or species at the top of the page.
- Each trip shows as a card — click **View details** to open the full record.
- The detail view shows everything: conditions, the fish table, your trolling route on a map, and the DWR report status.
- **Edit this session** sits right at the top of the detail — expand it to fix anything.
- **Delete this session** is at the very bottom, on purpose — it can't be undone.

## 5. Calendar

- A month grid of your season: **green** days = caught fish, **gray** days = skunked, white = no trip.
- Each trip day shows the fish count and location; the moon phase icon appears in the corner.

- Navigate with Prev / Next, jump to **Today**, or hit **Year ago** to compare against last season.
- Below the grid, every trip that month is listed — click **View** → to read the full detail without leaving the page.

## 6. Analytics

This is where the log pays off. Pick a year and browse the tabs:

- **Monthly:** trips, fish, and success rate by month.
- **Sizes:** how your fish measure up over the season.
- **Personal Bests:** your longest and heaviest fish, by species, with dates.
- **What's Working:** your most productive water temps, weather, baits, styles, and times — ranked by fish per hour.

## 7. Map

- Every trip's spot on one map, color-coded by how the day went: Skunked (0), Good (1–3), Great (4–6), Blowout (7+).
- Click a pin for the trip's date, conditions, bait, and catch.
- Turn on the **catch hotspots** checkbox for a heat map of everywhere you've actually caught fish.
- The same date/location/species filters apply, and there's a full-screen toggle.

## 8. Export (your backup)

The Export page downloads your data as CSV files that open in Excel or Google Sheets: **Sessions** (one row per trip) and **Fish** (one row per fish). These files are also your personal backup — grab a copy every month or so and stash it somewhere safe.

## 9. Using it on your phone

The app works in your phone's browser and is tuned for smaller screens — bigger buttons, a compact calendar, and a simpler layout.

- Tap the teal **Menu** button (top-left) to open the page list; it closes itself after you pick a page. When the menu is open, **Hide menu** tucks it away.
- **Make it feel like a real app:** in Safari or Chrome, tap Share → **Add to Home Screen**. You get a Fishing Log icon that opens full-screen, no address bar.
- The computer is still the best place for map-heavy work like setting trolling routes; the phone is great for logging a trip at the dock and checking your log anywhere.

## 10. Quick answers

**Is my data private?** Yes. Trips are tied to your email — each member sees only their own log.

**I got skunked. Do I still log it?** Absolutely — skunked trips are data too, and the DWR wants those reports just as much. Save the session with the fish table left empty.

**I made a mistake on a trip.** Browse & Search → open the trip → Edit this session (top of the detail). Fix it and Save changes.

**Can I lose my data?** It lives in a cloud database, not on your phone. For belt-and-suspenders, download the Export CSVs now and then.

**Something looks broken.** Note what page you were on and what you clicked, then tell John Parrent. The 'build' number at the bottom of the menu helps troubleshooting.

Tight lines!